

Vertigo



Approaching Dragonfly Peak, Mt Aspiring National Park - photo by Simon Williamson

Section News

Section Nights

In July we had our section night where Megan Sety and Carl Hammond presented on yoga and functional movement in the context of climbing. Megan and Carl were very entertaining speakers and had the audience contorting themselves into various shapes on the floor. Everyone seemed to enjoy the session and vouchers for a free class at HealthFit Collective were gratefully received by those who attended. If you're interested in finding out more you can book in for a free consultation with Carl at [HealthFit Collective](#)

On 19 July, Aviette presented on avalanche awareness to a big crowd. This was well received and provided a ton of information for the audience to digest. Don't forget to look up [avalanche.net.nz](#) for up to date avalanche conditions around the country as well as being a rich source of education about avalanche awareness. Apologies to those who weren't reminded of the evening until the last minute – there appeared to be some technical issues with getting the reminder sent out from National Office so not everybody got the reminder the week before.

August section night – Wednesday 3rd August - Back room at the Southern Cross, Abel Smith Street at 6pm

At the August section night we're lucky enough to have David Ellis presenting to the section at the Southern Cross. David is the founder and owner of the specialised outdoor clothing brand Earth Sea Sky and will talk about his 35 years experience of designing and making outdoor clothing and equipment in New Zealand. His grandfather started the Fairydown brand and supplied Sir Edmund Hillary with the sleeping bag he used during the first ascent of Mt Everest. His father joined the business and was the engineer who accompanied Hillary on his tractor trip to the South Pole. During the evening David, a keen outdoor enthusiast, will talk about his unique family heritage, remarkable people he has met, interesting places he has visited, some misunderstandings of functional clothing, the importance of efficient layering systems and how Earth Sea Sky survives in a world of exaggerated marketing claims, huge advertising budgets and discounts - A night of entertainment not to be missed!

Please don't forget the koha for section night – there'll be an ice bucket at the entry door for that purpose. ☺

Chair's Report

Another big thanks to Aviette for her excellent Avalanche Avoidance seminar at the last section night. Not easy to count heads from the corner of the room and with people coming in and out for beers but I estimated close to 70. It was certainly standing room only.

Our first snowcraft course of the season kicked off last weekend in ideal conditions. Ideal if you were in the lodge, not so much outside where it was truly gear testing weather. In spite of this feedback from participants was unanimously positive. We also had excellent feedback on the Manawatu lodge, being the first time we have used it for snow craft it is good to know the drying room works well. Though the weather was a little breezy with a touch of moisture in the air, it didn't prevent the enthusiastic students from getting out for a drenching and some self arresting practice. Unfortunately conditions didn't allow for much cramponing – often a challenge with the wet New Zealand snow pack. We also had our first youth (14 year old) participant on the course - from all accounts a keen enthusiast of the cold white stuff. We are keen to run more courses and provide more opportunities for younger people. If you are or know families or young people who are interested in rock and or alpine climbing please ask them to email the section.

Our next section night is shaping up to be another entertaining evening with David Ellis of Earth Sea Sky fame coming to give us the good oil on outdoor garments and the low down on what works, what doesn't and what isn't on the label. He might also tell us a bit about some of the more interesting parts of the planet. So get there early if you want a comfy chair. I should also say thanks to the kind contributor to my next trip to Thailand for leaving the Thai Baht in the Koha bucket.

On the trips front, Labour weekend is looking good with Nelson lakes (Alpine) and Paynes Ford (Rock) trips planned. Another trip to the top half of the South Island on the 8-9 October is in the planning – see details later in this edition of Vertigo. The good news for those keen to attend these South Island trips is that the committee will be funding rental vehicles to keep the costs down.

As always if you have any comments on what you liked or didn't like or would like send an email to us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or tweet us @NZACWellington or post a message on our facebook page www.facebook.com/nzacwellington.

Finally: "We do not live to eat and make money, we eat and make money to be able to enjoy life". -**George Mallory**

Simon

Chair: NZAC Wellington

For quick access to the section's page on the NZAC website, scan the below QR code.



Gear Hire

Don't forget the section has gear for hire : avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, helmets, crampons, probes and PLBs. If you're keen to hire some gear please fill in the form [here](#). Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on its return.

Financial guru wanted

Our annual accounts are due to be drawn up for the financial year and we are looking for a keen volunteer to help our treasurer through the process. If you are financial whiz or even if you understand the fundamentals and can offer a bit of your time please contact the committee on wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Upcoming Trips, Courses and Events

Wellington Section Trips

Ian Barnes has indicated he is keen to get a trip scheduled for 8-9 October with a preference for something in the top half of the South Island. Tapuae-o-Uenuku is a possibility but he's open to suggestions. Rental vehicle costs would be covered by the section so please contact Ian on ianbarnes@me.com if you're interested and to get in your vote for a destination. late September

Over Labour Weekend there are two trips to choose from – decide if you'd like to go rock-climbing or alpine climbing.

We're also considering a section trip to climb Mt Aspiring in November. There will likely be a limit on numbers for this trip, and skill and fitness level criteria to meet.

Keep an eye on our Facebook page for more details or email us on wellington@alpineclub.org.nz to let us know if you're keen to come along. Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the committee can help with advertising / logistics.

When?	Where?
8-9 October	Tapuae-o-Uenuku / other top of the South Island destination
Labour Weekend	Rock-climbing trip to Payne's Ford - led by Eric Duggan
Labour Weekend	Alpine climbing trip – probable destination is Mt Hopeless, Nelson Lakes – led by Simon Williamson
November	Mt Aspiring

Reel Rock 2016

Who enjoyed the Reel Rock 10 films we showed at the Southern Cross? Pretty sure there were plenty of people who came along who were wowed by the movies. The good news is that we're booking out Paramount for Reel Rock 11 on Wednesday 21 September. Keep the date free and keep an eye on our Facebook page – we'll let you know when you can book tickets and confirm the cost.

Snowcraft courses 2016

As mentioned in Simon's report, the first snowcraft course took place last weekend in slightly less than ideal weather conditions. Here's some feedback from one of the participants who was in the Intermediate group.

"Once again, NZAC lived up to its name as the country's premier alpine educational hub.

The result of last weekend's Intermediate Alpine course went beyond my expectation. Our field instructors, Kevin and Richard, did not allow the weather to have the upper hand over our training. When the weather was not conducive to outdoors activities, we utilised every available hour practising indoor rope work, applications of knots, belay and rappel systems, use of transceiver on mocked scenarios, etc.

And when the window of weather opportunity opened up, we were all out on the snow fields full-on - putting to practical use all the things that we were taught indoors.

Indeed, the professionalism and dedication of all of NZAC (Wellington) instructors & members under your leadership is praise worthy.

*Kind regards,
Jessie"*

Wellington Section Photo Competition 2016



Categories:

- Alpine Activity: climbing, skiing, whatever you do up high
Photographs where the main subject is people engaging in activity in the alpine environment (e.g. climbing, skiing, tramping, camping). Emphasis on careful composition and 'capturing the moment'.
- Alpine General: scenery and views that make you want to come back
Photographs that display mountain landscapes. Images should be strongly composed with great light. Judges will be weighing technical excellence, colour, tone and detail along with the image's subject and composition.
- Alpine Nature: the little gems of beauty along the way
Photographs of natural subjects in the mountain environment, where the emphasis is on artistic rendition. Subjects may include geological features, plants (or parts of plants), animals, water, snow and ice formations etc.
- Rock climbing: hardest moves, slickest lines
Photographs of rock climbing and bouldering that have strong visual impact and creative composition.

- Mountain and Climbing Culture: climbing life, places and people
Portray the climbing life and places and people encountered by climbers. Entries might include travel photography (as long as it's strongly related to climbing) or documentary-style images, covering any aspect of climbing.
- Humour: whatever gets you a laugh
- Kids photos
Alpine / climbing-related photos taken by kids aged 6 to 14 (please include age of the child when submitting entries in this category)

Judging criteria:

1. Category relevance – is the shot on subject, or should it be in a different category
2. Technical competence/excellence – is the shot exposed well – right balance of dark and light, no burn out. Is depth of field used well/is the shot appropriately focused
3. Creativity – what is different about the shot. Does an idea/story come through in the shot. Does it draw the viewer in/have emotional impact. What makes it more than just a pretty snap - unusual angle, choice of exposure settings, inclusion (or exclusion) of person or object to give context
4. Difficulty to shoot – dawn/dusk, challenging light, difficult to reach angle

1 and 2 are essential just to be accepted in category. 3 is what will define a winner, unless there are 2 winners, in which case 4, while not essential, might be the decider.

Prizes will be awarded to the best photo in each category.

Image Specifications:

- The closing date for the competition is the 8 August and the winners will be announced at the section night on Wednesday 7 September.
- Entries should be sent to peter.laurenson@clear.net.nz
- For each photo you need to supply a caption, the category, say who the photographer is and where and when the photo was taken.
- All images must have been taken by the competitor and be his or her property, but need not have been processed by him or her.
- Images need not necessarily have been taken in New Zealand.
- Entries are permitted in digital format only. Files must be JPEG format between 500KB and 3MB (at least 2000 pixels on the long side) will be accepted.
- Digital processing should be mostly restricted to dust removal, cropping, resizing, global exposure and tonal adjustments. HDR, and exposure, focus or sequence blending are permitted. Cloning or removing parts of an image (except in the case of the above) are not permitted. Obvious modification of images is not in keeping with the objectives of this competition and may result in disqualification.
- Images not meeting these specifications will not be judged.
- Please ensure you have permission from people in your photos that their image can be used and possibly published in Vertigo.

Judges

Peter Laurenson – photographer profile

Since leaving New Zealand for his OE in 1988, Peter and his camera have been drawn to many mountain places, in particular in Nepal, India, Pakistan and Tibet; and back home in New Zealand's beautiful high country; but to a few other interesting places too. From hiking and trekking beginnings he joined the NZAC in 2002 and has since become an occasional climber. Since 2004 he has won several Wellington Section and National NZAC annual photo competition awards, including the Overall winner (John Harrison memorial trophy) in 2014. To mark turning 50, in 2012 he climbed Aoraki Mount Cook with Guide Gary Dickson and then published a photographic book, Occasional Climber – a journey to Mount Clarity. He has since built a website www.occasionalclimber.co.nz, where you can view his thousands of images (presented in region and route-based slideshows) and order a copy of the book (43 copies left) if so inclined.

Nigel Roberts – photographer profile

Nigel Roberts has been taking photographs of mountains for more than fifty years. He first had climbing photographs published in David Dodds' book, A Cradle of Rivers: The Natal Drakenberg, in 1975. In 1979-80 he was New Zealand's Information Officer / Photographer in Antarctica, and while there he took his most famous photograph – of the koru symbol and tail of the Air New Zealand DC-10 that crashed on Mt Erebus. Like Peter Laurenson, Nigel also has a website, and a range of his climbing and other pictures can be seen on it (www.nigel-roberts.info). Last year Nigel Roberts had a photograph published in The Guardian Weekly (but it wasn't of a mountain – it was of Prince Harry during his visit to New Zealand).

Avalanche Awareness Presentation

If you missed Aviette's great presentation at the Southern Cross here's another event that you might want to get to. Andrew Hobman of [Avalanche NZ](#) will be presenting on understanding the destructive power of avalanches, when and why they happen, and how you can safely have fun in the mountains and avoid danger. This [event](#) is being held at the Bivouac store.

- Incredible prizes are on offer to willing participants.
- Great in store discounts exclusive to the evening.
- Tickets are \$5 and are sold at the door or in store before the event.
- All proceeds go towards the [Himalayan Trust](#).

Like Aviette's presentation, this will be a popular event so get your tickets early.



Avalanche debris above Tukino skifield, Mt Ruapehu

Trip Reports

NZAC North Island Ice-climbing meet

Location: TASC Lodge, Tukino Ski Field, Mt Ruapehu

Date: Weekend of July 8 • 10, 2016

Photos by Jonathan Cook



The annual North Island Ice Climbing Meet was held at TASC lodge on Tukino Skifield, Mt Ruapehu on the weekend of 8-10 July. There was a bit of soft snow on the road on Friday night and one vehicle had to be abandoned before the final hill.

The forecast for the weekend was poor so there were not huge numbers in attendance. Saturday was not too bad with the strong winds forecast only being moderate. It was quite warm on the Friday night so there was not much of a freeze. One group climbed Margarets Leap and several parties ascended Irish Ice Express on the Northern Bluffs. Bowel Wobbler was looked at but passed up due to the running water under the thin ice!



It was a nice clear night on Saturday and Sunday was a fine day with a good freeze over night. One party climbed Bowel Wobbler which was a bit thin in places but a good climb and another group set up a top rope here. Cathedral Rocks looked to be in good condition but no one from the meet ventured up that far!

Instructor Development Weekend at Temple Basin

Carolyn Ellis

Once again National Office scheduled a weekend in July at Temple Basin for alpine instructor development. Five instructors from the Wellington section travelled down for the weekend (three of us flying via Auckland to get to Christchurch – fun times) arriving at Temple Basin to find a distinct lack of snow. It was a little surreal staying in a ski lodge and being completely surrounded by tussock and rock with no snow in sight. We were joined by instructors from the Auckland and Central North Island sections as well as a group of professional guides who would be putting us through our paces.

On Saturday we split into groups and headed up the hill to find some snow. Eventually we arrived at Bill's Basin where there was enough snow to carry out the exercises set by the guides. Cramponing, self arresting, anchors and belay techniques were all covered off. We were lucky with the weather although it was certainly pretty cool out of the sun.

As per Temple Basin tradition there was a slap up meal provided on Saturday night and a reasonably early night for most attendees. Sunday morning saw the groups heading out for some navigation revision and transceiver searching before the usual lodge cleanup and debrief before departing homeward bound.

Outdoor First-Aid Training

Carolyn Ellis

Several Wellington section instructors took part in an outdoor first aid training weekend in July. The course was organised by [Outdoor Training NZ](#) who also run navigation, bushcraft and river safety courses. 16 people attended with a mix of Alpine Club and OTNZ members. The course itself was run at the Woolshed at the end of Stratton Street in Belmont Regional Park. Some realistic makeup and blood-curdling screaming made several of the scenarios feel a little too real – especially to some of the passers-by. A lot was learnt over the two days of the course with the result that those who attended feeling more confident on handling incidents in the outdoors. OTNZ will be running another course in the future so keep an eye on the website for any of their courses that you may be interested in. We'll be sure to advertise their courses through Vertigo as well.

Notices

NZAC Photographic Competition

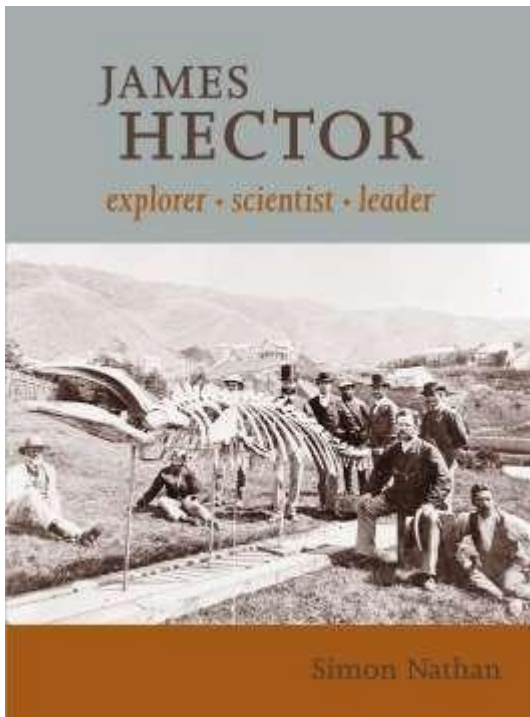
The NZAC will be opening the 2016 Photographic Competition for online entries on Monday 18th July through the <http://climber.co.nz/photo-competition/> website page. Entries close 4 September 2016 so start sorting through your images and get them in to win.

Potton and Burton - 20% discount to NZAC members

As new publications are released, specific titles will be made available to NZAC members at a 20% discount. The current offer and time limit to redeem the offer are detailed below. Information on the books' content may be found on the Potton and Burton website below.

Current Applicable title:

James Hector: explorer; scientist; leader by Simon Nathan
IISBN 9781877480461 RRP \$45.00



Discount and discount code:

20% off RRP by quoting Discount Code (viewable when logged in)

Free Freight within New Zealand

Dates available:

13 June – 30 September 2016

<http://www.pottonandburton.co.nz/store/james-hector>

NZAC member discounted rates at DOC huts

A reminder to members that you will need to have your ACTIVE NZAC membership card with you when paying hut fees at DOC offices to obtain discounted rates. They have no way to check your membership is active and will likely insist on seeing your card to give you member rates. NZAC won't be able to refund overpayments, so it is important to have your member card on you at the time of payment.

Remarkable's Mixed and Ice Festival Trip - Thursday 25 to Tuesday 30 August inclusive.

Jenny Cossey (Wellington Member) is organising a private trip to the Remarkable's Mixed and Ice Festival 2016. **This is not a supported NZAC Wellington Section or National Trip.** If you would like to attend with Jenny, further details are below.

This is the annual climbing meet of the Expedition Climbers Club Incorporated. Bringing together a huge cross section of climbers from around NZ and the world. Beginners get to rub shoulders and share the rope with the top winter alpine climbers in NZ. Clinics, competitions, races and social gatherings advance and promote modern mixed climbing. Showcasing the new and existing route potential on NZ's most accessible multi-pitch winter training area, the Remarkables. Sharing local knowledge and forming new climbing partnerships. Fundraising for the ECC Expedition Capital Fund.

For more information about the festival and what options are available see more at: <http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/#!/about/>. By signing up to the festival you automatically become a member of the Expedition Climbers Club to help raise funds for NZ expeditions overseas. Festival registration is now open on a first come, first serve basis. Festival registration closes three weeks prior to the festival or whenever the clinic/general climbing allocation is full.

For more information about the trip please contact Jenny Cossey.

Please confirm your Remarkable's Mixed and Ice Festival registration and Wellington to Queenstown flight tickets to trip organiser Jenny Cossey by July 31st to confirm your attendance.

Contact Jenny on jennycossey1@gmail.com 021 072 1000

NZAC 2017 Climbing Camp

The Otago Section will be hosting the 2017 climbing camp that will be from Saturday 4th to Saturday 11th February. The Camp will be based at the Top Forks Hut in the Wilkin Valley. As it is a 12 hour walk into the Top Forks hut it is proposed that people attending the camp travel by helicopter from Makarora.

Top Forks hut is in a stunning alpine environment and there are several peaks within striking distance of the hut, many of them grade 1 climbs. Campers are expected to be self-contained with their own tent, cooking equipment, fuel and food. We will have access to the hut but not exclusive use. We will be providing some basic communal facilities such as a tarp shelter, dish-washing facilities, toilet tent, thermos and a mountain radio.

We will limit the number of people attending the camp to 40 so early registration is recommended. You can obtain additional information and a registration form from the NZAC website. There will be a modest registration fee and you are expected to pay for your helicopter or jet boat travel to and from the camp. Budget on \$170 each way to/from Top Forks for the helicopter or \$110 each way for jet boat access via Kerin Forks Hut. Note: Top Forks is still a 6 hr walk from Kerin Forks. An option is to fly in and jet boat out.

The camp is suitable for climbers of all levels of experience but you must be an Alpine club member to attend. If you do not have a climbing partner at the camp we will arrange for you to team up with other climbers.

If you require additional information contact Keith Moffat Ph 03 473-8903 Mob 0276644037 or e-mail Moffat.k172@gmail.com

Wellington Section 2016 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Contact
Chairperson	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Co Chair	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Treasurer	Mark Leslie	027 338 4458
Secretary & Vertigo editor	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Patron	John Nankervis	
Other Committee Members	Aviette Musin	021 0299 5390
	Sharron Came	
	Gina Butson	
	Elisha Watson	
Rock Drill Overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 55 55 893

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